

Why Prices Won't Fall

FEBRUARY 8, 2010

Food price inflation is embedded in the DNA of the UPA regime. It created demand in the economy without tackling supply bottlenecks. Result: the *aam aadmi* is at the receiving end.



“ Shrinking land availability and over-exploitation of natural resources following unabated rise in the population of our country have made the prices of essential commodities go north. ”

RATAM SHARGA, via www.indiatoday.in

Pricey Politics

The prices of basic food items have been on the rise for a year now and are still rising despite the stability in the overall price level (“Why Prices Won't Fall”, February 8). This has affected household budgets and has left our politicians nervous. It is worth remembering that food prices have always been politically sensitive: there were elections that were supposed to have been won or lost over the price of onions. The Supreme Court has rightly described the situation faced by the common man as “terrible”.

VINOD C. DIXIT, *Ahmedabad*

The main reason for food price inflation is the neglect of the farmer and the resultant fall in agricul-



Man in Charge

With the beleaguered Tamils having backed the wrong horse during the elections, they might be at a disadvantage to press their cause (“Now for the Hard Part”, February 8). One hopes that for lasting peace and stability of Sri Lanka, Mahinda Rajapaksa would abide by his electoral manifesto and refrain from indulging in unabashed nepotism that he is now being accused of.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Rajapaksa's decisive victory over the LTTE will pave the way for Sri Lanka's economic resurgence. He must clearly understand that the growing influence of China in the country's affairs works against India's unconditional economic assistance to the country.

S. LAKSHMI, via www.indiatoday.in

tural production. Our bureaucrats are more concerned about agricultural growth than farmers' poverty. An increase in agricultural production doesn't ensure improvement in farmers' living standards. Faster poverty reduction can go a long way in increasing farm production and bringing food prices down.

KANGAYAM R. NARASIMHAN,
Chennai

The prices of all commodities are increasing and the Government's attitude towards handling the crisis is rather laid-back. Earlier, the Government controlled the prices by raiding the hoarders. Now with the private players entering the scene, things have changed drastically. Their only motive is to make money, and the

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